

CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD
CENTRAL VALLEY REGION

ORDER NO. 98-166

WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS
FOR
COUNTY OF TULARE
BUILDING SERVICES AND PARKS DEPARTMENT
SEQUOIA FIELD WASTEWATER TREATMENT FACILITY
TULARE COUNTY

The California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Central Valley Region, (hereafter Board) finds that:

1. The County of Tulare, Building Services and Parks Department, (hereafter Discharger) submitted a Report of Waste Discharge, dated 29 January 1998, in support of expansion of and increase in flow from its wastewater treatment facility (WWTF) at its Bob Wiley Detention Center and the Tulare County Correctional Center. The property (Assessor's Parcel No. 048-040-09) is in Tulare County, about nine miles north of Visalia, and is owned by the County.
2. Waste Discharge Requirements Order No. 94-046, adopted by the Board on 25 February 1994, prescribes requirements for a monthly average discharge of 0.22 million gallons per day (mgd) of wastewater from the WWTF. Order No. 94-046 prescribes conditions for treatment of wastewater in two extended aeration basins and disposal of the effluent to three on-site evaporation/percolation ponds.
3. In 1997, the Discharger expanded its WWTF to accommodate an increase in flow to the WWTF from a new boot camp and a juvenile detention center that it plans to build near the Bob Wiley Detention Center. The expanded WWTF consists of two lift stations; two headworks with bar screens and a parshall flume for flow measurement; three extended aeration basins; a sludge bagging unit; and four sludge drying beds.
4. Disposal of wastewater from the expanded WWTF is to five evaporation/percolation ponds (three on-site and two off-site) and to 129 acres of pasture land. The total capacity of the ponds is 134 acre-feet. There are 75 acres of the pasture land on-site and 54 acres off-site. The off-site ponds and the pasture land (Assessor's Parcel No. 47-040-38) are about 0.75 miles north of the WWTF and are also owned by the County of Tulare.
5. The Discharger has submitted a technical report along with the Report of Waste Discharge which demonstrates that the expanded WWTF has capacity to treat and dispose 0.44 mgd of wastewater. Existing flow at the WWTF is around 0.14 mgd.

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6. Based on the Discharger's monitoring, the average influent BOD and Total Suspended Solids (TSS) are 336 mg/l and 253 mg/l, respectively. The average effluent BOD, TSS, nitrate nitrogen, and conductivity (specific electrical conductance at 25°C, also EC) are 11 mg/l, 12 mg/l, 21 mg/l, and 682 μ mhos/cm, respectively.
7. Source water for the detention centers, correctional center, and the boot camp is from five wells. The EC of the source water varies from 320 to 870 μ mhos/cm.
8. Order No. 94-046 required the Discharger to submit a workplan by 30 April 1994 on soil sampling at the wastewater recycling area. In September 1997, the Discharger submitted the required workplan.
9. Sludge generated at the treatment plant is applied as soil amendment material on the wastewater recycling area.
10. The WWTF is in Sections 12 and 13, T17S, R24E, MDB&M, as shown in Attachment A, which is attached hereto and part of this Order by reference. Surface water drainage is to Cottonwood Creek and St. Johns River, both valley floor waters. The site lies within the Kaweah Delta Hydrologic Area (No. 558.10) in the South Valley Floor Hydrologic Unit, as depicted on interagency hydrologic maps prepared by the Department of Water Resources in August 1986.
11. The *Water Quality Control Plan for the Tulare Lake Basin, Second Edition*, (hereafter Basin Plan), designates beneficial uses, establishes water quality objectives, and contains implementation plans and policies for all waters of the Basin. These requirements implement the Basin Plan.
12. The beneficial uses of valley floor waters, as identified in the Basin Plan, include industrial and agricultural supply; water contact and non-contact water recreation; warm fresh water habitat; preservation of rare and endangered species; and groundwater recharge.
13. Based on the information obtained from the "*Lines of Equal Elevation of Water in Wells in Unconfined Aquifer*," published by the Department of Water Resources in Spring 1996, the depth of groundwater in the region is about 50 feet below ground surface. A geotechnical investigation performed by the Discharger shows that perched groundwater exists at the site at depths ranging from 18 to 38 feet.
14. The beneficial uses of underlying groundwater are domestic, industrial, and agricultural supply.

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15. The Discharger has provided information on soils at the treatment plant site and at the new disposal site. At the treatment plant site, soils within the upper 23 feet beneath the site consist of clayey sands, silty clays, clayey silts, and occasional layers of sand. Surface soils exhibit infiltration rates of about 0.003 feet per day. At the new disposal site, the upper 5 to 10 feet of the on-site soils is comprised of sandy clay and clayey sand. Below a 10 feet strata of sand, silty sand, sandy silt, sandy clay, and clayey sand are present. On-site testing shows infiltration rate of the soils to be 0.375 to 0.625 feet per day.
16. The Regional Board has considered antidegradation pursuant to State Board Resolution No. 68-16 and finds that the permitted discharge is consistent with those provisions, and is unlikely to cause an increase in groundwater constituents above that of background levels.
17. Based on the information obtained from the Department of Water Resources, the annual precipitation in the area is around 12 inches and the annual pan evaporation is around 84 inches.
18. The California Department of Health Services has established statewide criteria in Title 22, California Code of Regulations (CCR), Section 60301 et seq., for the use of recycled water and has developed guidelines for specific uses.
19. The Board consulted with the Department of Health Services, the Tulare County Health Department, and the appropriate Mosquito Abatement District, and considered their recommendations regarding public health aspects for use of recycled water.
20. The County of Tulare as the lead agency prepared an Environmental Impact Report (EIR) for the project and on 10 June 1997 certified a final EIR in accordance with the California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA) (Public Resources Code Section 21100, et seq.). The Board has considered the EIR and concurs there are no significant impacts on water quality.
21. The Board has notified the Discharger and interested agencies and persons of its intent to prescribe waste discharge requirements for this discharge and has provided them with an opportunity for a public hearing and an opportunity to submit their written views and recommendations.
22. The Board, in a public meeting, heard and considered all comments pertaining to the discharge.

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IT IS HEREBY ORDERED that Order No. 94-046 is rescinded and the County of Tulare, its agents, successors, and assigns, in order to meet the provisions contained in Division 7 of the California Water Code and regulations adopted thereunder, shall comply with the following:

A. Discharge Prohibitions

1. Discharge of wastes to surface waters or surface water drainage courses is prohibited.
2. Bypass or overflow of untreated or partially treated waste is prohibited except as allowed in Provision E.2 of Standard Provisions and Reporting Requirements.
3. Discharge of waste classified as 'hazardous', as defined in Section 2521(a) of Title 23, CCR, Section 2510, et seq., or 'designated', as defined in Section 13173 of the California Water Code, is prohibited.
4. The use of untreated or partially treated waste for irrigation is prohibited.
5. Grazing of milking animals within the area irrigated with effluent is prohibited unless such irrigation has ceased for at least thirty days.

B. Discharge Specifications

1. The monthly average discharge shall not exceed 0.44 mgd.
2. The discharge shall remain within the designated treatment and disposal area at all times.
3. Objectionable odors originating at this facility shall not be perceivable beyond the limits of the wastewater treatment and disposal area.
4. As a means of discerning compliance with Discharge Specification No. B.3, the dissolved oxygen content in the upper zone (1 foot) of wastewater in all ponds shall not be less than 1.0 mg/l.
5. The treatment facilities and disposal areas shall be operated and maintained to prevent inundation or washout due to rainfall with a 100-year return frequency.

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6. The effluent from the extended aeration basins, prior to disposal, shall not exceed the following limits:

<u>Constituent</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>Monthly Average</u>	<u>Daily Maximum</u>
BOD ₅ ¹	mg/l	40	80
Total Suspended Solids	mg/l	40	80
Settleable Solids	ml/l	0.2	0.5

¹ Five-day, 20° Celsius biochemical oxygen demand

7. The maximum conductivity of the discharge shall not exceed 1000 µmhos/cm, or the average source water EC plus 500 µmhos/cm, whichever is less.
8. Ponds shall not have a pH less than 6.5 or greater than 8.5.
9. Ponds shall be managed to prevent breeding of mosquitoes. In particular:
- a. An erosion control program should assure that small coves and irregularities are not created around the perimeter of the water surface.
 - a. Weeds shall be minimized through control of water depth, harvesting, or herbicides.
 - b. Dead algae, vegetation, and debris shall not accumulate on the water surface.
10. Pond levees shall be maintained free of obstructions and be of sufficient width (greater than 10 feet) to provide reasonable, safe, and effective access to vector control personnel.
11. The ponds, in conjunction with disposal on land, shall have sufficient capacity to accommodate allowable wastewater flow and design seasonal precipitation and ancillary inflow and infiltration. Design seasonal precipitation shall be based on total annual precipitation using a return period of 100 years, distributed monthly in accordance with historical rainfall patterns. Freeboard shall never be less than two feet (measured vertically to the lowest point of overflow).

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12. On or about 15 October of each year, available pond storage capacity shall at least equal the volume necessary to comply with Discharge Specification B.11.

C. Sludge Disposal Specifications

1. Collected screenings, sludges, and other solids removed from liquid wastes shall be disposed of in a manner approved by the Executive Officer and consistent with *Consolidated Regulations for Treatment, Storage, Processing, or Disposal of Solid Waste*, as set forth in Title 27, CCR, Division 2, Subdivision 1, Section 20005, et seq.
2. Any proposed change in sludge use or disposal practice shall be reported to the Executive Officer and USEPA Regional Administrator at least 90 days in advance of the change.
3. Use and disposal of sewage sludge shall comply with existing federal and state laws and regulations, including permitting requirements and technical standards included in 40 CFR 503.

If the State Water Resources Control Board and the Regional Water Quality Control Boards assume primacy to implement regulations contained in 40 CFR 503, this Order may be reopened to incorporate appropriate time schedules and technical standards. The standards and time schedules contained in 40 CFR 503 apply whether or not they have been incorporated into this Order.

D. Groundwater Limitations

The discharge, in combination with other sources, shall not cause underlying groundwater to contain waste constituents in concentrations statistically greater than background water quality, except for conductivity. Regarding conductivity, the discharge shall not cause groundwater to exceed an incremental increase in conductivity greater than 15 $\mu\text{mhos/cm}$ over the most recent five-year period.

E. Recycled Water Specifications

1. The recycling of wastewater shall be limited to furrow or flood irrigation of pasture, fodder, fiber, or seed crops for non human consumption.
2. Recycled water shall remain within the designated application area at all times.

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3. Recycled water used for irrigation shall be managed to minimize erosion.
4. The Discharger shall maintain the following setback distances from areas irrigated with recycled water:

<u>Setback Distance (feet)</u>	<u>To</u>
25	Property line
30	Public roads
50	Drainage courses
100	Irrigation wells
150	Domestic wells

5. The perimeter of the application area shall be graded to prevent ponding along public roads or other public areas.
6. Application of recycled water to the application area shall be at reasonable rates considering the crop, soil, climate, and irrigation management system.
7. Areas irrigated with recycled water shall be managed to prevent breeding of mosquitoes. More specifically:
 - a. All applied irrigation water must infiltrate completely within a 48-hour period.
 - b. Ditches must be maintained free of emergent, marginal, and floating vegetation.
 - c. Low-pressure and unpressurized pipelines and ditches accessible to mosquitoes shall not be used to store water.
8. All areas where recycled water is used shall be posted with conspicuous signs that present the following wording in size that can be clearly read by the public:

“NO TRESPASSING - RECLAIMED WATER - DO NOT DRINK”
or
“NO TRESPASSING - RECYCLED WATER - DO NOT DRINK”

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The signs will have the universal "Do not drink" cross-out underneath the wording (See Attachment B).

9. No physical connection shall exist between recycled water piping and any domestic water supply well, or between recycled water piping and any irrigation well that does not have an air gap or reduced pressure principle device.

F. Provisions

1. The Discharger shall comply with Monitoring and Reporting Program No. 98-166, which is part of this Order, and any revisions thereto as ordered by the Executive Officer.
2. The Discharger shall comply with the "Standard Provisions and Reporting Requirements for Waste Discharge Requirements," dated 1 March 1991, which are attached hereto and by reference a part of this Order. This attachment and its individual paragraphs are commonly referenced as "Standard Provision(s)."
3. In the event of any change in control or ownership of land or waste discharge facilities described herein, the Discharger shall notify the succeeding owner or operator of the existence of this Order by letter, a copy of which shall be immediately forwarded to this office.

To assume operation under this Order, the succeeding owner or operator must apply in writing to the Executive Officer requesting transfer of the Order. The request must contain the requesting entity's full legal name, the State of incorporation if a corporation, the name and address and telephone number of the persons responsible for contact with the Board, and a statement. The statement shall comply with the signatory paragraph of Standard Provision B.3 and state that the new owner or operator assumes full responsibility for compliance with this Order. Failure to submit the request shall be considered a discharge without requirements, a violation of the California Water Code. Transfer shall be approved or disapproved by the Executive Officer.

4. The Discharger must comply with all conditions of this Order, including timely submittal of technical and monitoring reports as directed by the Executive Officer. Violations may result in enforcement action, including Regional Board or court orders requiring corrective action or imposing civil monetary liability, or in revision or rescission of this Order.

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5. A copy of this Order shall be kept at the WWTF for reference by wastewater treatment plant operating personnel. Key operating personnel shall be familiar with its contents.
6. If reclaimed water is used for construction purpose, it shall comply with the most current edition of *Guidelines for Use of Reclaimed Water for Construction Purposes*. Other uses of reclaimed water not specifically authorized herein shall be subject to the approval of the Executive Officer and shall comply with 22 CCR, Division 4.
7. The Board will review this Order periodically and will revise requirements when necessary.

I, GARY M. CARLTON, Executive Officer, do hereby certify the foregoing is a full, true, and correct copy of an Order adopted by the California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Central Valley Region, on 24 July 1998.



GARY M. CARLTON, Executive Officer

SH:sh/fmc: 7/24/98

CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD
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INFLUENT MONITORING

Influent samples shall be collected at the inlet of the headworks and approximately the same time as effluent samples. Influent monitoring shall include at least the following:

<u>Constituent</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>Type of Sample</u>	<u>Frequency</u>
Flow	mgd	Metered	Continuously
BOD ₅	mg/l	Grab	Weekly ¹
Total Suspended Solids	mg/l	Grab	Weekly ¹

¹ Frequency shall be weekly for the first six months, thereafter twice per month.

EFFLUENT MONITORING

Effluent samples shall be collected just prior to discharge to the ponds. Effluent samples shall be representative of the volume and nature of the discharge. Time of collection of the sample shall be recorded. Effluent monitoring shall include at least the following:

<u>Constituent</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>Type of Sample</u>	<u>Frequency</u>
pH	pH Units	Grab	Weekly ¹
Settleable Solids	ml/l	Grab	Weekly ¹
BOD ₅	mg/l	Grab	Weekly ¹
EC	µmhos/cm	Grab	Weekly ¹
Total Suspended Solids	mg/l	Grab	Weekly ¹

¹ Frequency shall be weekly for the first six months, thereafter twice per month.

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<u>Constituent</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>Type of Sample</u>	<u>Frequency</u>
Total Nitrogen	mg/l	Grab	Quarterly
Total Dissolved Solids	mg/l	Grab	Annually

POND MONITORING

The freeboard shall be monitored on all ponds to the nearest tenth of a foot. Pond monitoring shall include at least the following:

<u>Constituent</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>Type of Sample</u>	<u>Frequency</u>
Dissolved Oxygen ¹	mg/l	Grab	Weekly
Freeboard	feet	Observation	Weekly

¹ Samples shall be collected from each pond near the outlet and analyzed for dissolved oxygen. Samples shall be collected between 0800 and 0900 hours.

Permanent markers shall be placed in the ponds with calibration indicating the water level at design capacity and available operational freeboard.

In addition, the Discharger shall inspect the condition of the ponds once per week and write visual observations in a bound log book. Notations shall include observations of whether weeds are developing in the water or along the bank, and their location; whether dead algae, vegetation, scum, or debris are accumulating on the pond surface and their location; whether burrowing animals or insects are present; and the color of the ponds (e.g., dark sparkling green, dull green, yellow, gray, tan, brown, etc.). A copy of the entries made in the log during each month shall be submitted along with the monitoring report the following month. Where the operation and maintenance manual indicates remedial action is necessary, the Discharger shall briefly explain in the transmittal what action has been taken or is scheduled to be taken.

WATER SUPPLY MONITORING

The Discharger shall conduct annual monitoring of the supply water for EC. If the source water is from more than one source, the EC shall be reported as a weighted average and copies of the supporting calculations shall be included.

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WASTEWATER RECYCLING AREA MONITORING

The wastewater recycling area shall be monitored according to the following:

<u>Constituent</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>Type of Sample</u>	<u>Frequency</u>
Flow	mgd	Estimate	Daily
Area irrigated	acres	Estimate	Monthly

In addition, a minimum of five representative locations (three at the 75-acres of pasture land and two at the 54-acres of pasture land) and one background location (outside the wastewater recycling area) shall be established for soil profile monitoring. The soil samples shall be tested for the following constituents:

<u>Constituent</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>Type of Sample</u>	<u>Frequency</u>
Nitrate Nitrogen	mg/Kg	5 feet ¹	Annually
Kjeldahl Nitrogen	mg/Kg	5 feet ¹	Annually
Soluble Salts	mg/Kg	5 feet ¹	Annually

¹ Samples shall be collected at depths of one, three, and five feet from the ground surface.

SLUDGE MONITORING

A composite sample of sludge shall be collected annually in accordance with EPA's *POTW SLUDGE SAMPLING AND ANALYSIS GUIDANCE DOCUMENT, AUGUST 1989*, and tested for the following metals:

Arsenic	Cadmium	Chromium	Copper	Lead
Mercury	Nickel	Selenium	Zinc	

Sampling records shall be maintained for a minimum of five years. A log shall be kept of sludge quantities generated and handling and disposal activities.

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The Discharger shall submit annual reports containing the following:

- a. Annual sludge production in dry tons and percent solids.
- b. A schematic diagram showing sludge handling facilities and solids flow diagram.
- c. Depth of application and drying time for sludge drying beds.
- d. A description of disposal methods, including the following information related to the disposal methods used at the facility. If more than one method is used, include the percentage of annual sludge production disposed by each method.
 - (1) For **landfill disposal**, include: (a) the Order numbers of WDRs that regulate the landfill(s) used, (b) the present classifications of the landfill(s) used, and (c) the names and locations of the facilities receiving sludge.
 - (2) For **land application**, include: (a) the locations of the site(s), (b) the Order numbers of any WDRs that regulate the site(s), (c) the application rate in pounds/acre/year (specify wet or dry), and (d) subsequent uses of the land.
 - (3) For **incineration**, include: (a) the names and locations of the site(s) where sludge incineration occurs, (b) the Order numbers of WDRs that regulate the site(s), (c) the disposal method of ash, and (d) the names and locations of facilities receiving ash (if applicable).
 - (4) For **composting**, include: (a) the location of the sites(s), and (b) the Order numbers of any WDRs that regulate the site(s).

Prior to any disposal or land application of sewage sludge, or removal of sewage sludge from the wastewater treatment plant site, the monitoring and record keeping requirements of 40 CFR 503 shall be met.

REPORTING

Daily, weekly, and monthly monitoring data shall be reported in monthly monitoring reports. Monthly monitoring reports shall be submitted to the Board by the **20th day of the following month**. Quarterly monitoring reports shall be submitted by the **20th day of the month following each calendar quarter**. Annual monitoring reports shall be submitted by **31 January of each year**.

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In reporting the monitoring data, the Discharger shall arrange the data in tabular form so that the date, the constituents, and the concentrations are readily discernible. The data shall be summarized in such a manner that illustrates clearly whether the Discharger complies with waste discharge requirements.

If the Discharger monitors any pollutant at the locations designated herein more frequently than is required by this Order, the results of such monitoring shall be included in the discharge monitoring report.

The Discharger may also be requested to submit an annual report to the Board with tabular and graphical summaries of the monitoring data obtained during the previous year. Any such request shall be made in writing. The report shall discuss the corrective actions taken and planned to bring the discharge into full compliance with the waste discharge requirements.

By 31 January of each year, the Discharger shall submit a written report to the Executive Officer containing the following:

- a. The names, certificate grades, and general responsibilities of persons in charge of wastewater treatment and disposal.
- b. The names and telephone numbers of persons to contact regarding the facility for emergency and routine situations.
- c. A statement certifying when the flow meter and other monitoring instruments and devices were last calibrated, including identification of who performed the calibration (Standard Provision C.4)
- d. A statement identifying whether the current operation and maintenance manual, and contingency plan, reflect the wastewater treatment plant as currently constructed and operated, and the dates when these documents were last reviewed for adequacy.
- e. The total quantity of sludge disposed of during the previous year and ultimate disposal site(s).

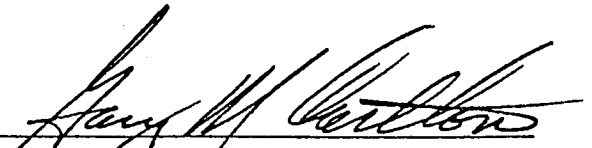
All reports submitted in response to this Order shall comply with the signatory requirements in Standard Provision B.3.

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The Discharger shall implement the above monitoring program on the first day of the month following adoption of this Order.

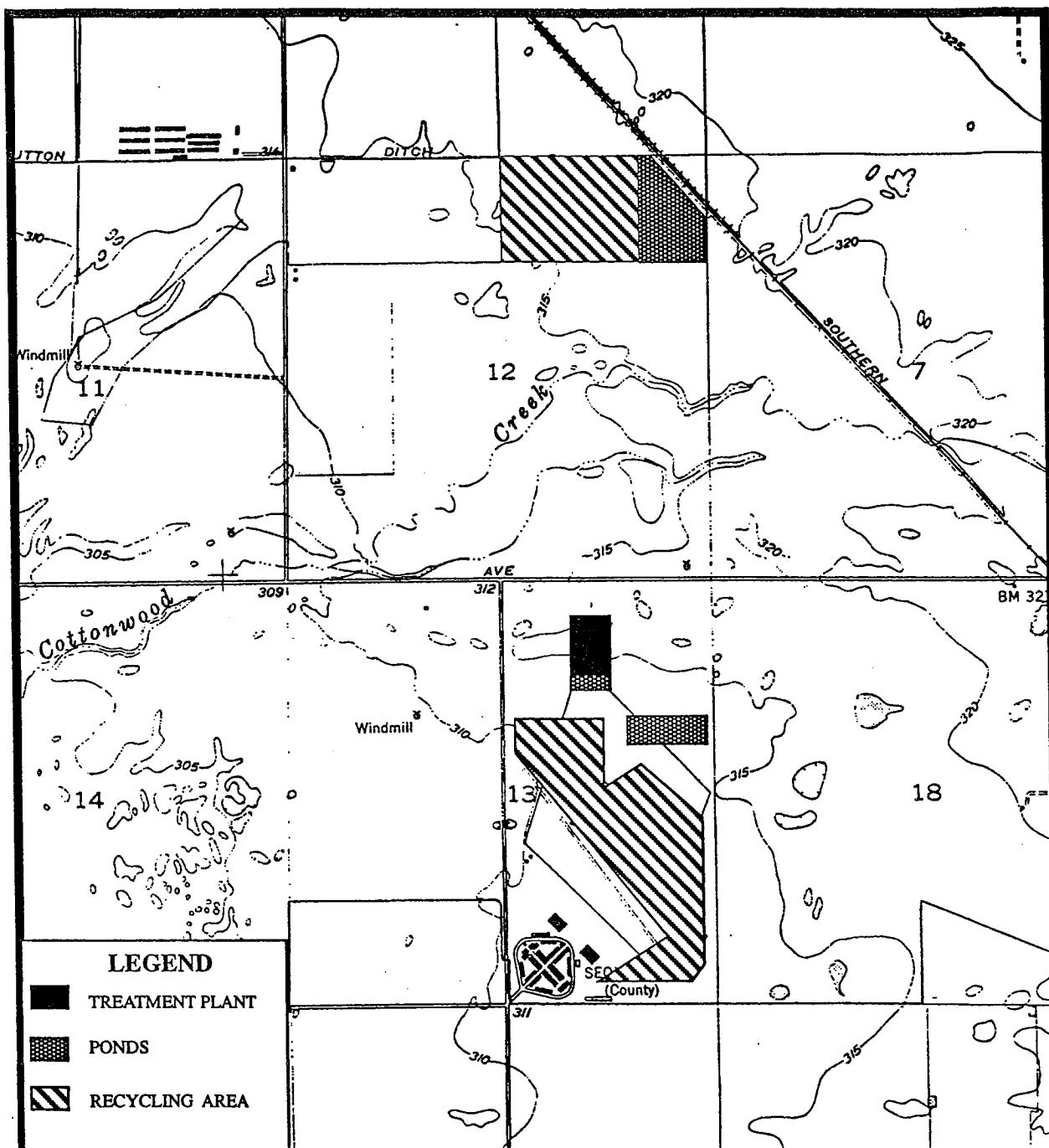
Ordered by:


GARY M. CARLTON, Executive Officer

24 July 1998

(Date)

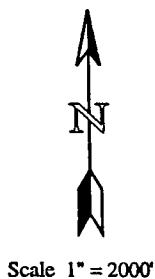
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ATTACHMENT A Vicinity Map

COUNTY OF TULARE
DEPARTMENT OF BUILDING SERVICES AND PARKS
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Sections 12 & 13, T17S, R24E, MDB&M
Monson, 7 1/2' USGS Quad





INFORMATION SHEET

COUNTY OF TULARE BUILDING SERVICES AND PARKS DEPARTMENT SEQUOIA FIELD WASTEWATER TREATMENT FACILITY TULARE COUNTY

The County of Tulare, Building Services and Parks Department owns and operates the Sequoia Field Wastewater Treatment Facility (WWTF) about nine miles north of Visalia. The WWTF treats wastewater from Bob Wiley Detention Center and the Tulare County Correctional Center located nearby. In 1997, the Discharger expanded the WWTF to accommodate additional flows from a boot camp and a juvenile detention center that are proposed to be constructed near the Bob Wiley Detention Center.

The expanded WWTF has a capacity to treat and dispose 0.44 mgd of wastewater. It consists of two lift stations; two headworks with bar screens and a parshall flume for flow measurement; three extended aeration basins; a sludge bagging unit; and four sludge drying beds. Disposal of wastewater from the expanded WWTF is to five percolation/evaporation ponds (three on-site and two off-site) and to 129 acres of pasture land (75 acres on-site and 54 acres off-site). The off-site ponds and the pasture land are also owned by the County of Tulare and are about 0.75 miles north of the WWTF.

The California Department of Health Services (DHS) has established statewide criteria in Title 22, for the use of recycled water and has developed guidelines for specific uses. This Order includes criteria and guidelines developed by DHS.

Surface water drainage from the facility is to Cottonwood Creek and to St. Johns River, both valley floor waters. The beneficial uses of valley floor waters are industrial and agricultural supply; water contact and non-contact water recreation; warm fresh water habitat; preservation of rare and endangered species; and groundwater recharge.

Groundwater in the region is about 50 feet below the ground surface. A geotechnical investigation performed by the Discharger shows that perched groundwater exists at the site at depths ranging from 18 to 38 feet. The beneficial uses of the underlying groundwater are domestic, industrial, and agricultural supply.

At the treatment plant site, soils within the upper 23 feet beneath the site consists of clayey sands, silty clays, clayey silts, and occasional layers of sand. Surface soils exhibit infiltration rates of about 0.003 feet per day. At the new disposal site, the upper 5 to 10 feet of the on-site soils comprise of sandy clay and clayey sand. Below a 10 feet strata of sand, silty sand, sandy silt, sandy clay, and clayey sand are present. On-site testing shows infiltration rate of the soils to be 0.375 to 0.625 feet per day.

INFORMATION SHEET - Continued

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Based on the information obtained from the Department of Water Resources, the annual precipitation in the area is around 12 inches and the annual pan evaporation is around 84 inches.

The County of Tulare as the lead agency prepared an Environmental Impact Report (EIR) for the project and on 10 June 1997 certified a final EIR in accordance with the California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA) (Public Resources Code Section 21100, et seq.).

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